WHY MOVE TO DALLAS

The DFW Family Relocation Guide

A practical workbook for choosing a suburb, checking schools by address, budgeting the true monthly cost and planning your move.

NOVEMBER 2026 EDITION · 12 SUBURB PROFILES · WORKSHEETS AND CHECKLISTS

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How to use this guide

Moving a family across the country means making a big decision from far away. This guide is built to help you narrow the field in an organized way, then check the details that matter before you commit.

1. **Start with your priorities.** Fill in the shortlist worksheet before you read a single profile. It keeps the decision about your family, not about a list.
2. **Read the suburb pages side by side.** Each profile is one page with the same layout: dated market figures, the school districts that serve the city, practical notes and room for your own.
3. **Check the address, not the city.** Schools, taxes, utilities and HOA rules are set by the address. The checklists show you how to confirm each one.
4. **Budget the full monthly cost.** Two homes at the same price can have very different tax rates, HOA dues and district assessments.
5. **Plan the move.** The timeline and first 30 days checklist cover the Texas deadlines new residents need to meet.

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> Compiled November 6, 2026 using the source dates shown. Market figures are historical, not predictions. Worksheets and checklists are designed to be printed.

PRINTABLE WORKSHEET

Your shortlist worksheet

Score how much each factor matters to your family, then note how each suburb on your list measures up for you. There are no right answers; this is your family's list.

WHAT MATTERS TO US	IMPORTANCE 1 TO 5	SUBURB A	SUBURB B	SUBURB C
Suburb names				
School district and campus fit				
Commute for each working adult				
Total monthly budget				
New construction or established neighborhood				
Lot size and outdoor space				
Activities for your kids				
Shopping and dining nearby				
Distance to the airport or family				
Our own factor				

OUR NON-NEGOTIABLES

QUESTIONS TO BRING TO OUR FIRST CALL

> Bring this page to a call with Kristen and she can help you test your shortlist against the addresses and budgets you are considering. Book a time.

How to read the suburb pages

The twelve profiles that follow are in alphabetical order. The order is not a ranking, and no profile says one suburb is better than another. The right fit depends on your family.

POPULATION

Each page shows the city's population from the Census Bureau's American Community Survey five-year estimate for 2019 to 2023, rounded to the nearest thousand. Newer estimates exist, and our live suburb pages may show a slightly different figure.

MARKET FIGURES

The four market figures come from NTREIS, the North Texas multiple listing service, for single-family homes in each city. Each one averages the 12 most recent monthly values that NTREIS reported, ending with October 2026; homes sold is the total of those months. Averaging smooths out swings in months with few sales, so the price is not a single month's median and not the median of every sale in the year. A month with no reported value is skipped, so the 12 values may not be 12 back-to-back months. Figures were retrieved November 1, 2026, are rounded and describe the past, not future prices. NTREIS reports by its own city areas, which may not match the Census city limits used for population and school district shares. For current homes for sale, use the search link on each suburb page.

SCHOOL DISTRICTS

Each page lists every district that covers at least half a percent of the city's land area, from federal NCES EDGE boundaries (school year 2024 to 2025) intersected with Census city limits. Land area is not the same as the share of homes, and attendance zones inside a district change. Always confirm the assigned campus for a specific address.

WHAT THIS GUIDE LEAVES OUT, ON PURPOSE

This guide does not rate or compare neighborhoods by safety, crime or who lives there. Every family weighs those questions differently. To research an area directly, use your local police department's public crime map, NeighborhoodScout or City-Data. Drive times are left out too, because they change by hour. Check your own route at rush hour before you choose.

Where the 12 suburbs are

These 12 suburbs are a selection, not a complete list. The Dallas Fort Worth area includes many more cities, and whymovetodallas.com profiles about 70 of them.



Schematic only. Each navy dot marks an approximate representative location for the city from our suburb data; it does not show city limits, size or shape. Gold dots are approximate reference points. Not for navigation.

POPULATION ABOUT 108,000 · CENSUS ACS 2019 TO 2023 ESTIMATE

Allen

A Collin County city along US 75 between Plano and McKinney, with established neighborhoods and some newer communities.

SINGLE-FAMILY MARKET, 12 REPORTED MONTHS ENDING OCTOBER 2026*

$515,000	32 days	3.0	990
average of the monthly median sale prices	average days on market	average months of supply	homes sold, total of the 12 months

SCHOOL DISTRICTS SERVING THE CITY

Allen ISD	91% of city area
Plano ISD	5% of city area
McKinney ISD	2% of city area
Lovejoy ISD	2% of city area

Share of city land area, not of homes. Boundaries do not follow city lines; confirm the assigned campus for each address.

ON YOUR VISIT

- [ ] Drive your commute at the hours you would actually drive it
- [ ] Call the district to confirm campuses for specific addresses
- [ ] Walk the streets you like at different times of day
- [ ] Ask about MUD, PID and HOA costs for specific homes

GOOD TO KNOW

- Watters Creek and the Village at Allen are shopping and dining districts in the city.
- DART light rail does not run into Allen; the nearest stations are in Plano.
- Several school districts serve parts of the city; confirm assignment by address.

OUR NOTES

Live data for Allen at whymovetodallas.com Search homes for sale in Allen

*NTREIS single-family data for the city, averaging the 12 most recent reported monthly values ending October 2026 (homes sold is their total), retrieved November 1, 2026. Prices rounded to the nearest $5,000. Historical, not a forecast. Population rounded to the nearest thousand. District shares: NCES EDGE boundaries (school year 2024 to 2025) intersected with Census city limits.

POPULATION ABOUT 5,000 · CENSUS ACS 2019 TO 2023 ESTIMATE

Argyle

A town in Denton County along US 377 and FM 407. Properties range from acreage to newer subdivisions, so lot size and setting vary from street to street.

SINGLE-FAMILY MARKET, 12 REPORTED MONTHS ENDING OCTOBER 2026*

$570,000	58 days	5.2	420
average of the monthly median sale prices	average days on market	average months of supply	homes sold, total of the 12 months

SCHOOL DISTRICTS SERVING THE CITY

Argyle ISD	96% of city area
Northwest ISD	4% of city area

Share of city land area, not of homes. Boundaries do not follow city lines; confirm the assigned campus for each address.

ON YOUR VISIT

- [ ] Drive your commute at the hours you would actually drive it
- [ ] Call the district to confirm campuses for specific addresses
- [ ] Walk the streets you like at different times of day
- [ ] Ask about MUD, PID and HOA costs for specific homes

GOOD TO KNOW

- Ask whether a property uses a private well or septic system before you write an offer.
- Nearby communities can carry an Argyle mailing address but sit in a different town or school district.
- Some properties may carry agricultural valuation or deed restrictions; review the tax statement and title documents.

OUR NOTES

Live data for Argyle at whymovetodallas.com

Search homes for sale in Argyle

*NTREIS single-family data for the city, averaging the 12 most recent reported monthly values ending October 2026 (homes sold is their total), retrieved November 1, 2026. Prices rounded to the nearest $5,000. Historical, not a forecast. Population rounded to the nearest thousand. District shares: NCES EDGE boundaries (school year 2024 to 2025) intersected with Census city limits.

POPULATION ABOUT 27,000 · CENSUS ACS 2019 TO 2023 ESTIMATE

Celina

A city in Collin and Denton counties north of Prosper along Preston Road (SH 289), with newer master-planned communities alongside a historic downtown square.

SINGLE-FAMILY MARKET, 12 REPORTED MONTHS ENDING OCTOBER 2026*

$510,000	68 days	6.6	1,710
average of the monthly median sale prices	average days on market	average months of supply	homes sold, total of the 12 months

SCHOOL DISTRICTS SERVING THE CITY

Celina ISD	79% of city area
Prosper ISD	20% of city area
Pilot Point ISD	under 1%

Share of city land area, not of homes. Boundaries do not follow city lines; confirm the assigned campus for each address.

ON YOUR VISIT

- [ ] Drive your commute at the hours you would actually drive it
- [ ] Call the district to confirm campuses for specific addresses
- [ ] Walk the streets you like at different times of day
- [ ] Ask about MUD, PID and HOA costs for specific homes

GOOD TO KNOW

- Some newer communities include a MUD or PID, which adds to the tax or assessment line. Ask for the notice early.
- Check planned road and school projects near any lot you consider.
- Builder incentives change often, so compare the full contract terms, not only the price.

OUR NOTES

Live data for Celina at whymovetodallas.com

Search homes for sale in Celina

*NTREIS single-family data for the city, averaging the 12 most recent reported monthly values ending October 2026 (homes sold is their total), retrieved November 1, 2026. Prices rounded to the nearest $5,000. Historical, not a forecast. Population rounded to the nearest thousand. District shares: NCES EDGE boundaries (school year 2024 to 2025) intersected with Census city limits.

POPULATION ABOUT 26,000 · CENSUS ACS 2019 TO 2023 ESTIMATE

Colleyville

A Tarrant County city between Dallas and Fort Worth, west of DFW Airport along SH 26, with established neighborhoods and a range of lot sizes.

SINGLE-FAMILY MARKET, 12 REPORTED MONTHS ENDING OCTOBER 2026*

$1,010,000	20 days	2.4	310
average of the monthly median sale prices	average days on market	average months of supply	homes sold, total of the 12 months

SCHOOL DISTRICTS SERVING THE CITY

Grapevine-Colleyville ISD	85% of city area
Keller ISD	10% of city area
Hurst-Euless-Bedford ISD	5% of city area
Carroll ISD	under 1%

Share of city land area, not of homes. Boundaries do not follow city lines; confirm the assigned campus for each address.

ON YOUR VISIT

- [ ] Drive your commute at the hours you would actually drive it
- [ ] Call the district to confirm campuses for specific addresses
- [ ] Walk the streets you like at different times of day
- [ ] Ask about MUD, PID and HOA costs for specific homes

GOOD TO KNOW

- Several school districts serve parts of the city, so confirm assignment by address.
- Ask about current new construction options alongside resale homes.
- The Colleyville Nature Center offers trails and ponds inside city limits.

OUR NOTES

Live data for Colleyville at whymovetodallas.com

Search homes for sale in Colleyville

*NTREIS single-family data for the city, averaging the 12 most recent reported monthly values ending October 2026 (homes sold is their total), retrieved November 1, 2026. Prices rounded to the nearest $5,000. Historical, not a forecast. Population rounded to the nearest thousand. District shares: NCES EDGE boundaries (school year 2024 to 2025) intersected with Census city limits.

POPULATION ABOUT 42,000 · CENSUS ACS 2019 TO 2023 ESTIMATE

Coppell

A city on the north side of DFW Airport with established neighborhoods.

SINGLE-FAMILY MARKET, 12 REPORTED MONTHS ENDING OCTOBER 2026*

$635,000	21 days	2.7	340
average of the monthly median sale prices	average days on market	average months of supply	homes sold, total of the 12 months

SCHOOL DISTRICTS SERVING THE CITY

Coppell ISD	85% of city area
Carrollton-Farmers Branch ISD	12% of city area
Lewisville ISD	2% of city area
Grapevine-Colleyville ISD	1% of city area

Share of city land area, not of homes. Boundaries do not follow city lines; confirm the assigned campus for each address.

ON YOUR VISIT

- [ ] Drive your commute at the hours you would actually drive it
- [ ] Call the district to confirm campuses for specific addresses
- [ ] Walk the streets you like at different times of day
- [ ] Ask about MUD, PID and HOA costs for specific homes

GOOD TO KNOW

- Check aircraft noise at different times of day, given the airport next door.
- Old Town Coppell is a small downtown district with shops, dining and events.
- Several school districts serve parts of the city; confirm assignment by address.

OUR NOTES

Live data for Coppell at whymovetodallas.com

Search homes for sale in Coppell

*NTREIS single-family data for the city, averaging the 12 most recent reported monthly values ending October 2026 (homes sold is their total), retrieved November 1, 2026. Prices rounded to the nearest $5,000. Historical, not a forecast. Population rounded to the nearest thousand. District shares: NCES EDGE boundaries (school year 2024 to 2025) intersected with Census city limits.

POPULATION ABOUT 78,000 · CENSUS ACS 2019 TO 2023 ESTIMATE

Flower Mound

A town in Denton County on the north shore of Grapevine Lake, north of DFW Airport and served by FM 2499 and FM 1171, with established neighborhoods and newer communities.

SINGLE-FAMILY MARKET, 12 REPORTED MONTHS ENDING OCTOBER 2026*

$640,000	25 days	2.8	910
average of the monthly median sale prices	average days on market	average months of supply	homes sold, total of the 12 months

SCHOOL DISTRICTS SERVING THE CITY

Lewisville ISD	71% of city area
Argyle ISD	17% of city area
Northwest ISD	9% of city area
Denton ISD	3% of city area

Share of city land area, not of homes. Boundaries do not follow city lines; confirm the assigned campus for each address.

ON YOUR VISIT

- [ ] Drive your commute at the hours you would actually drive it
- [ ] Call the district to confirm campuses for specific addresses
- [ ] Walk the streets you like at different times of day
- [ ] Ask about MUD, PID and HOA costs for specific homes

GOOD TO KNOW

- The town has a trail network and lake access points at Grapevine Lake.
- Several school districts serve parts of the town, so the address matters as much as the town name.
- Utility providers and HOA arrangements vary across the town; confirm them for each address.

OUR NOTES

Live data for Flower Mound at whymovetodallas.com

Search homes for sale in Flower Mound

*NTREIS single-family data for the city, averaging the 12 most recent reported monthly values ending October 2026 (homes sold is their total), retrieved November 1, 2026. Prices rounded to the nearest $5,000. Historical, not a forecast. Population rounded to the nearest thousand. District shares: NCES EDGE boundaries (school year 2024 to 2025) intersected with Census city limits.

POPULATION ABOUT 210,000 · CENSUS ACS 2019 TO 2023 ESTIMATE

Frisco

A large city in Collin and Denton counties along the Dallas North Tollway and SH 121, with established neighborhoods and newer communities.

SINGLE-FAMILY MARKET, 12 REPORTED MONTHS ENDING OCTOBER 2026*

$670,000	38 days	4.6	2,140
average of the monthly median sale prices	average days on market	average months of supply	homes sold, total of the 12 months

SCHOOL DISTRICTS SERVING THE CITY

Frisco ISD	83% of city area
Prosper ISD	10% of city area
Lewisville ISD	4% of city area
Little Elm ISD	2% of city area

Share of city land area, not of homes. Boundaries do not follow city lines; confirm the assigned campus for each address.

ON YOUR VISIT

- [ ] Drive your commute at the hours you would actually drive it
- [ ] Call the district to confirm campuses for specific addresses
- [ ] Walk the streets you like at different times of day
- [ ] Ask about MUD, PID and HOA costs for specific homes

GOOD TO KNOW

- The Star (the Dallas Cowboys headquarters) and the PGA of America headquarters are in Frisco.
- Several school districts serve parts of the city; confirm assignment by address.
- If your routes use toll roads, add tolls to your monthly budget.

OUR NOTES

Live data for Frisco at whymovetodallas.com Search homes for sale in Frisco

*NTREIS single-family data for the city, averaging the 12 most recent reported monthly values ending October 2026 (homes sold is their total), retrieved November 1, 2026. Prices rounded to the nearest $5,000. Historical, not a forecast. Population rounded to the nearest thousand. District shares: NCES EDGE boundaries (school year 2024 to 2025) intersected with Census city limits.

POPULATION ABOUT 16,000 · CENSUS ACS 2019 TO 2023 ESTIMATE

Highland Village

A Denton County city on the shore of Lewisville Lake, along FM 407 and FM 2499, with established neighborhoods.

SINGLE-FAMILY MARKET, 12 REPORTED MONTHS ENDING OCTOBER 2026*

$615,000	24 days	2.7	200
average of the monthly median sale prices	average days on market	average months of supply	homes sold, total of the 12 months

SCHOOL DISTRICTS SERVING THE CITY

Lewisville ISD	100% of city area

Share of city land area, not of homes. Boundaries do not follow city lines; confirm the assigned campus for each address.

ON YOUR VISIT

- [ ] Drive your commute at the hours you would actually drive it
- [ ] Call the district to confirm campuses for specific addresses
- [ ] Walk the streets you like at different times of day
- [ ] Ask about MUD, PID and HOA costs for specific homes

GOOD TO KNOW

- The Shops at Highland Village is a retail and dining center in the city.
- Lake access includes parks and trails along Lewisville Lake.
- Use the months of supply figure above to set expectations for your search timing.

OUR NOTES

Live data for Highland Village at whymovetodallas.com

Search homes for sale in Highland Village

*NTREIS single-family data for the city, averaging the 12 most recent reported monthly values ending October 2026 (homes sold is their total), retrieved November 1, 2026. Prices rounded to the nearest $5,000. Historical, not a forecast. Population rounded to the nearest thousand. District shares: NCES EDGE boundaries (school year 2024 to 2025) intersected with Census city limits.

POPULATION ABOUT 202,000 · CENSUS ACS 2019 TO 2023 ESTIMATE

McKinney

The Collin County seat, along US 75 and SH 121, with a historic downtown square, established central neighborhoods and newer communities.

SINGLE-FAMILY MARKET, 12 REPORTED MONTHS ENDING OCTOBER 2026*

$510,000	43 days	3.6	3,060
average of the monthly median sale prices	average days on market	average months of supply	homes sold, total of the 12 months

SCHOOL DISTRICTS SERVING THE CITY

McKinney ISD	73% of city area
Prosper ISD	12% of city area
Frisco ISD	10% of city area
Allen ISD	3% of city area
Lovejoy ISD	under 1%
Melissa ISD	under 1%

Share of city land area, not of homes. Boundaries do not follow city lines; confirm the assigned campus for each address.

ON YOUR VISIT

- [ ] Drive your commute at the hours you would actually drive it
- [ ] Call the district to confirm campuses for specific addresses
- [ ] Walk the streets you like at different times of day
- [ ] Ask about MUD, PID and HOA costs for specific homes

GOOD TO KNOW

- Several school districts serve parts of the city; confirm assignment by address.
- The historic downtown square hosts shops, restaurants and seasonal events.
- Newer communities may include a MUD or PID; ask for the notice before you sign.

OUR NOTES

Live data for McKinney at whymovetodallas.com

Search homes for sale in McKinney

*NTREIS single-family data for the city, averaging the 12 most recent reported monthly values ending October 2026 (homes sold is their total), retrieved November 1, 2026. Prices rounded to the nearest $5,000. Historical, not a forecast. Population rounded to the nearest thousand. District shares: NCES EDGE boundaries (school year 2024 to 2025) intersected with Census city limits.

POPULATION ABOUT 287,000 · CENSUS ACS 2019 TO 2023 ESTIMATE

Plano

A large city in Collin and Denton counties with established neighborhoods. The Legacy area hosts major corporate campuses, including Toyota Motor North America's headquarters.

SINGLE-FAMILY MARKET, 12 REPORTED MONTHS ENDING OCTOBER 2026*

$530,000	29 days	3.1	2,180
average of the monthly median sale prices	average days on market	average months of supply	homes sold, total of the 12 months

SCHOOL DISTRICTS SERVING THE CITY

Plano ISD	87% of city area
Frisco ISD	9% of city area
Lewisville ISD	4% of city area
Allen ISD	under 1%

Share of city land area, not of homes. Boundaries do not follow city lines; confirm the assigned campus for each address.

ON YOUR VISIT

- [ ] Drive your commute at the hours you would actually drive it
- [ ] Call the district to confirm campuses for specific addresses
- [ ] Walk the streets you like at different times of day
- [ ] Ask about MUD, PID and HOA costs for specific homes

GOOD TO KNOW

- DART light rail serves stations in Plano, including Downtown Plano.
- On older homes, budget for updates and check the ages of major systems.
- Parts of the city are in Frisco ISD or Lewisville ISD rather than Plano ISD.

OUR NOTES

Live data for Plano at whymovetodallas.com Search homes for sale in Plano

*NTREIS single-family data for the city, averaging the 12 most recent reported monthly values ending October 2026 (homes sold is their total), retrieved November 1, 2026. Prices rounded to the nearest $5,000. Historical, not a forecast. Population rounded to the nearest thousand. District shares: NCES EDGE boundaries (school year 2024 to 2025) intersected with Census city limits.

POPULATION ABOUT 35,000 · CENSUS ACS 2019 TO 2023 ESTIMATE

Prosper

A town in Collin and Denton counties north of Frisco, along the Dallas North Tollway and US 380. It includes newer master-planned communities, some with HOA amenity centers.

SINGLE-FAMILY MARKET, 12 REPORTED MONTHS ENDING OCTOBER 2026*

$830,000	64 days	6.1	730
average of the monthly median sale prices	average days on market	average months of supply	homes sold, total of the 12 months

SCHOOL DISTRICTS SERVING THE CITY

Prosper ISD	92% of city area
Denton ISD	8% of city area

Share of city land area, not of homes. Boundaries do not follow city lines; confirm the assigned campus for each address.

ON YOUR VISIT

- [ ] Drive your commute at the hours you would actually drive it
- [ ] Call the district to confirm campuses for specific addresses
- [ ] Walk the streets you like at different times of day
- [ ] Ask about MUD, PID and HOA costs for specific homes

GOOD TO KNOW

- HOA dues and amenity fees vary between communities; get the resale certificate or builder disclosure.
- Part of the town lies in Denton ISD rather than Prosper ISD; confirm by address.
- Check planned road projects near any home you consider.

OUR NOTES

Live data for Prosper at whymovetodallas.com

Search homes for sale in Prosper

*NTREIS single-family data for the city, averaging the 12 most recent reported monthly values ending October 2026 (homes sold is their total), retrieved November 1, 2026. Prices rounded to the nearest $5,000. Historical, not a forecast. Population rounded to the nearest thousand. District shares: NCES EDGE boundaries (school year 2024 to 2025) intersected with Census city limits.

POPULATION ABOUT 31,000 · CENSUS ACS 2019 TO 2023 ESTIMATE

Southlake

A Tarrant County city northwest of DFW Airport along SH 114. Southlake Town Square is the city's mixed-use center and home to city hall.

SINGLE-FAMILY MARKET, 12 REPORTED MONTHS ENDING OCTOBER 2026*

$1,395,000	17 days	3.8	390
average of the monthly median sale prices	average days on market	average months of supply	homes sold, total of the 12 months

SCHOOL DISTRICTS SERVING THE CITY

Carroll ISD	77% of city area
Northwest ISD	13% of city area
Keller ISD	7% of city area
Grapevine-Colleyville ISD	3% of city area

Share of city land area, not of homes. Boundaries do not follow city lines; confirm the assigned campus for each address.

ON YOUR VISIT

- [ ] Drive your commute at the hours you would actually drive it
- [ ] Call the district to confirm campuses for specific addresses
- [ ] Walk the streets you like at different times of day
- [ ] Ask about MUD, PID and HOA costs for specific homes

GOOD TO KNOW

- Several school districts serve parts of the city, so confirm assignment by address.
- Lot size, home age and updates can drive wide price differences between homes.
- Ask about current new construction options alongside resale homes.

OUR NOTES

Live data for Southlake at whymovetodallas.com

Search homes for sale in Southlake

*NTREIS single-family data for the city, averaging the 12 most recent reported monthly values ending October 2026 (homes sold is their total), retrieved November 1, 2026. Prices rounded to the nearest $5,000. Historical, not a forecast. Population rounded to the nearest thousand. District shares: NCES EDGE boundaries (school year 2024 to 2025) intersected with Census city limits.

PRINTABLE CHECKLIST

Checking schools by address

In DFW, the school a child attends is set by the home's address, and district lines often cross city lines. Use this checklist for every home you seriously consider.

- [ ] Find the district for the exact address, using the district's own attendance boundary or school finder tool.
- [ ] Confirm the elementary, middle and high school campuses assigned to that address for the coming school year. Fast-growing districts redraw zones.
- [ ] Look up each campus on TXschools.gov. The Texas Education Agency released 2026 ratings on August 14, 2026. They are preliminary until appeals are decided; TEA's 2026 calendar schedules final ratings for December 11, 2026.
- [ ] Ask the district about capacity, overflow assignment and any planned new campuses near the address.
- [ ] Ask about the programs your child needs: gifted and talented, special education services, dual language, advanced academics, fine arts or athletics.
- [ ] Check transfer policies if you are buying in one district and hoping to attend another.
- [ ] Gather enrollment documents: proof of residency (often a closing statement or lease), your child's birth certificate, immunization records and prior school records.
- [ ] Note enrollment dates and any registration windows for pre-K, kindergarten or specialty programs.

ADDRESS	ASSIGNED CAMPUSES

> Private and charter schools have their own application calendars, often a year ahead. If you are considering them, start early.

PRINTABLE WORKSHEET

True monthly cost worksheet

Compare homes on the full monthly cost, not the list price. Fill in one column per home.

MONTHLY COST	HOME A	HOME B
Principal and interest From your lender's loan estimate		
Property taxes, not counting any MUD Each unit: its taxable value times its rate per $100, divided by 100. Add the units, then divide by 12		
MUD tax, if the home is in one Same method with the MUD rate and MUD taxable value. Count it only here		
PID assessment, if any The annual assessment from the PID notice, divided by 12		
HOA dues and amenity fees From the resale certificate or builder disclosure; note any transfer fees		
Homeowners insurance Quote it during your option period; wind and hail coverage varies		
Flood insurance Ask even outside a mapped flood zone		
Mortgage insurance If your down payment is under 20% or your loan type requires it		
Electricity Ask the seller for 12 months of bills; summers drive usage		
Water, sewer and trash Set by the city or utility district		
Internet Check providers for the exact address		
Tolls and commuting Include tolls if your routes use toll roads		
Maintenance reserve A yearly set-aside for repairs and upkeep, divided by 12		
Total per month		

The next page shows how to estimate property tax and what to ask about insurance.

Property tax and insurance, explained

ESTIMATING PROPERTY TAX

Several local units tax each home: the school district, county and city, and sometimes a college, hospital, MUD or other district. Each sets a rate per $100 of taxable value and applies its own exemptions, so each unit can have a different taxable value for the same home.

> **For each unit:** taxable value × rate ÷ 100 = annual tax.
> Example with illustrative numbers: $500,000 × 0.50 ÷ 100 = $2,500 a year, or about $208.33 a month.
> Do this for every unit on the tax statement, add the results and divide by 12. A MUD is calculated the same way and counted once.

- Once you qualify, the residence homestead exemption takes $140,000 off the value your school district taxes. Other units may offer their own optional exemptions.
- The seller's current bill can be lower than yours will be, because it may reflect the seller's exemptions or a capped taxable value.
- On a new build, the latest bill may cover only the lot. Estimate taxes on the value of the completed home.
- A PID charges an assessment rather than a rate; use the annual amount from the PID notice.

QUESTIONS TO ASK ABOUT HOMEOWNERS INSURANCE

- [ ] Is the wind and hail deductible a flat amount or a percentage of dwelling coverage? What is it in dollars?
- [ ] Will a roof claim be paid at replacement cost or actual cash value? Does that change with the roof's age?
- [ ] Does the roof's age, material or condition affect eligibility or price?
- [ ] Is the dwelling covered for the cost to rebuild, not the purchase price?
- [ ] Do you need flood insurance? It is a separate policy, and new policies usually have a waiting period before coverage starts.
- [ ] Get the quote early in your option period so it can inform your decision.

Compare insurers and complaint records at HelpInsure, run by the Texas Department of Insurance.

PRINTABLE WORKSHEET

Cash to close and moving budget

Plan the cash you need before, at and after closing. Your lender's loan estimate and closing disclosure have the official figures.

ITEM	AMOUNT
PAID BEFORE CLOSING	
Option fee Paid to the seller; your contract says whether it is credited at closing	
Earnest money Held by the title company and credited toward your cash to close	
Inspections General, plus any specialists	
Appraisal and application fees Per your lender	
DUE AT CLOSING	
Down payment Purchase price minus your loan amount	
Lender, title and escrow charges Remaining charges not already paid or listed above	
Prepaid insurance, taxes and escrow deposits From your loan estimate	
HOA transfer and resale certificate fees If the home is in an HOA	
Less: earnest money, credited option fee, seller and lender credits Subtract each one once	
MOVING AND SETTLING IN	
Scouting trips and temporary housing	
Movers	
Utility deposits and setup	
Vehicle registration and driver license fees	
Window coverings, landscaping and first repairs	
Total cash needed	

Earnest money, a credited option fee and any seller or lender credits reduce your cash to close. Count each payment and each credit once.

Texas essentials for new residents

HOMESTEAD EXEMPTION

Once you own and live in the home as your principal residence, file Form 50-114 with your county appraisal district. It removes $140,000 from the value your school district taxes. Ask the appraisal district about timing if you buy partway through the year.

PROPERTY TAX PROTESTS

Each spring your appraisal district sends a notice of appraised value. If you disagree, the usual deadline to protest is May 15 or 30 days after the notice, whichever is later.

REGISTER YOUR VEHICLES, IN THIS ORDER

1. Get Texas auto insurance that meets the state minimum.
2. If your county requires it (Collin, Dallas, Denton and Tarrant are among them), pass an emissions inspection.
3. Within 30 days of moving, register at your county tax office with Form 130-U, your insurance card and proof of ownership. Some offices need appointments.

Safety inspections for noncommercial vehicles ended January 1, 2025.

GET YOUR TEXAS DRIVER LICENSE

With a valid license from another U.S. state you can generally drive on it for up to 90 days after moving; apply for your Texas license within that time. DPS asks that your vehicles be registered in Texas before you apply. Offices work by appointment, so book early.

ELECTRICITY

Addresses in the competitive retail market can choose an electricity provider; compare plans at PowerToChoose.org. Others are served by an electric cooperative or a city utility with no provider choice. Check the specific address.

WEATHER AND YOUR HOME

Plan for hot summers, spring storms and occasional hard freezes. Ask about roof age and hail history, how the foundation has been maintained, and where the water shutoff is located.

Rules change. The official source for each item is listed on the Sources page; confirm the current requirement before you act.

How buying works in Texas

1. **Sign a written agreement before touring.** Starting January 1, 2026, Texas law requires a written agreement with a license holder before they show you a home, or before they present an offer if they did not show it. It can be a buyer representation agreement or a nonrepresentation showing agreement. Open houses hosted by the listing brokerage are an exception. Compensation in these agreements is negotiable; read the terms before you sign.
2. **Get a full preapproval.** Ask your lender for a preapproval based on reviewed income and assets, and compare at least two loan estimates.
3. **Make an offer.** Resale purchases written by license holders generally use the TREC one to four family resale contract. You negotiate the price, earnest money, option fee and option period, closing date and who pays which costs. Earnest money is usually held by the title company.
4. **Use the option period.** If your contract includes an option period and you deliver the option fee on time, you can end the contract for any reason by giving the seller written notice of termination before the option period expires. Schedule inspections, insurance quotes and document review early in that window.
5. **Review the disclosures.** Expect the Seller's Disclosure Notice on most resale homes, plus MUD or PID notices and HOA documents where they apply.
6. **Title, survey and appraisal.** A title company handles the closing and the title policy. Review the title commitment and survey for easements and encroachments.
7. **Close.** Ask early whether your lender and title company allow remote or mail-away closing if you will not be in Texas. Confirm wiring instructions by calling the title company at a number you find independently. Never rely on emailed wiring instructions alone.

> Contract terms are negotiable and every transaction is different. Ask your agent, lender and title company to walk you through each deadline in your contract.

PRINTABLE CHECKLIST

Property due diligence checklist

Work through this list for each home you put under contract. Start on day one so the time sensitive items fit inside the option period.

THE HOUSE

- [ ] General inspection by a licensed inspector, even on new construction
- [ ] Foundation evaluation if the inspector flags movement
- [ ] Roof age, hail history and insurance claims history
- [ ] Heating, cooling and water heater ages
- [ ] Drainage and grading around the foundation
- [ ] Sewer line scope on older homes
- [ ] Pool or spa inspection, if present

THE PAPERWORK

- [ ] Seller's Disclosure Notice
- [ ] MUD and PID notices, if the home is in a district
- [ ] HOA resale certificate, budget and rules
- [ ] Current tax statement and exemptions
- [ ] Survey, easements and title commitment
- [ ] Permits for additions, pools or major updates

THE LOCATION

- [ ] Flood zone on FEMA flood maps
- [ ] Assigned campuses for the address
- [ ] Planned roads, zoning and development nearby
- [ ] Airport, rail and highway noise at different hours
- [ ] Your commute at the hours you will drive it

THE COSTS

- [ ] Insurance quote before the option period ends; compare at HelpInsure
- [ ] Electricity provider and 12 months of usage
- [ ] Internet providers for the address
- [ ] Full monthly cost worksheet completed

New construction or resale

Both paths work well for relocating families. They ask different questions.

NEW CONSTRUCTION

- Bring your agent on your first visit to a model home, and ask about the builder's agent registration policy.
- The builder's contract is not the TREC resale contract. Read the deposit, delay and warranty terms closely.
- Incentives often depend on using the builder's lender or title company. Compare the full cost against outside offers.
- Hire an independent inspector before drywall and again before closing.
- Ask about MUD and PID assessments, HOA dues and amenity fees, which can be higher in newer communities.
- Ask whether landscaping, window coverings and fencing are included or extra.
- Build times vary; plan housing for the gap if your move date is fixed.

RESALE

- Established trees, finished landscaping and known neighborhood character.
- Ages of the roof, heating and cooling, and water heater drive near term costs.
- You can see the actual home, lot and street before you commit.
- Option period and inspection give you a defined window to evaluate the home.
- Closing timelines are often shorter and more predictable than a build.
- Updates and repairs may be needed; get estimates during the option period.
- Older neighborhoods are less likely to carry new MUD or PID assessments, but check every address.

> Browse current new home communities through Kristen's new construction search, then compare them against resale on the full monthly cost worksheet.

PRINTABLE CHECKLIST

Your move timeline

A typical sequence for a family buying from out of state. Adjust it to your contract dates.

90 days out

- [ ] Complete your shortlist worksheet
- [ ] Talk with a lender and get a full preapproval
- [ ] Sign a written agreement with your agent before touring
- [ ] Research school districts and campuses by address
- [ ] Set a total monthly budget, not just a price

60 days out

- [ ] Take a scouting trip, or tour by live video
- [ ] Drive your commute at rush hour
- [ ] Narrow to two or three suburbs
- [ ] Request MUD, PID and HOA details on homes you like
- [ ] Get insurance quotes on a sample address

30 days out

- [ ] Write an offer and schedule inspections on day one of the option period
- [ ] Review disclosures, survey and title commitment
- [ ] Book movers and set utility start dates
- [ ] Contact the school district about enrollment
- [ ] Confirm wiring instructions by phone

Closing week

- [ ] Final walkthrough
- [ ] Sign closing documents in person or remotely as approved
- [ ] Collect keys, codes, garage openers and manuals

PRINTABLE CHECKLIST

Your first 30 days

The Texas deadlines that matter most after you arrive, with the everyday setup around them.

Week 1

- [ ] Change the locks and garage codes
- [ ] Set up electricity, water, trash and internet
- [ ] Locate the water shutoff and breaker panel
- [ ] Enroll your children and request records transfers

Weeks 2 and 3

- [ ] Register your vehicles (within 30 days of moving)
- [ ] Then apply for your driver license (within 90 days)
- [ ] Update your address with your bank, employer and USPS
- [ ] Find a pediatrician, dentist and urgent care

Week 4

- [ ] File your homestead exemption once you qualify
- [ ] Register to vote at your new address
- [ ] Learn your trash, recycling and watering schedules
- [ ] Join the HOA or neighborhood channels, if any

> Keep your closing statement handy. Schools, the appraisal district and other offices often accept it as proof of residency.

Sources

Official sources were checked on November 6, 2026. Market figures: NTREIS, retrieved November 1, 2026. Population: Census ACS 2019 to 2023 five-year estimates.

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Contact and disclosures

TALK THROUGH YOUR MOVE

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BROKERAGE AND LICENSE

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General TREC resources: the Information About Brokerage Services form explains the types of real estate brokerage services, and the TREC Consumer Protection Notice explains how to reach TREC. These links are general information, not a completed brokerage disclosure. Ask for the brokerage's completed Information About Brokerage Services form before you discuss a specific property.

FAIR HOUSING

Equal Housing Opportunity. We are committed to the letter and spirit of the federal Fair Housing Act and the Texas Fair Housing Act, and we do not discriminate on the basis of race, color, religion, sex, disability, familial status or national origin.

ABOUT THIS GUIDE

This guide is general information for relocating families, not legal, tax, lending or insurance advice. Market figures are historical and do not predict future prices or values. School assignments, ratings, tax rates and fees change; verify each one for the specific property. Information was believed accurate as of November 6, 2026.